



Siemens M35i

This phone sports a grey-black duotone design and features some very thoughtful touches. For example, the battery bay is lined with rubber, which increases the phone's resistance to moisture and dust. At 125 grams, this is not a light phone. Its weight can be attributed to the NiMH battery pack that it uses. There's a battery discharge feature built into the phone for completely draining the battery before recharging it. The buttons on the phone are rather rubbery but they offer a good grip and are easy to operate. Even the rear battery cover of the phone is rubber coated and this significantly improves grip and makes the phone impervious to rough usage. The layout of the buttons is, however, slightly cramped and you need to press many buttons while navigating through the menu—you often have to use both hands. There are four games included in the phone. You can set reminders, but there is no support for calendaring. This phone also supports WAP. For first-time users, there is a quick start guide that visually indicates common processes such as loading your SIM card, changing your battery, etc. One salient feature with this phone is the 200-entry phonebook memory. With a very robust construction, this phone is a good choice for people who are constantly on the road.

Siemens M35i	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Warranty	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

B+ Price: Rs 9,995

- + Very tough construction, large phonebook memory, WAP support
- NiMH battery, cramped button layout; you often need to use both hands

kit lets you tune in to and listen to your favourite FM channel with absolute ease.

Other phones that exhibited very good features were the Nokia 5510 and the Samsung SGH-M100 with their support for MP3 playback through their integrated memory (64 MB in the former and 32 MB in the latter). The Samsung

SGH-M100 features headphones that have an in-line controller that lets you control the MP3 playback. You can even switch over to receive a phone call while you're listening to MP3 audio. The Nokia 5510 bundles the necessary audio encoding and transfer software. In the package we received, there was also an

Phone Care



- Never keep your cell phone near heat and magnetic sources (gas stove, direct sunlight, audio speakers, etc).
- Avoid dropping it as it could damage the delicate circuits inside the phone. Use a wrist strap or a belt clip. Covering your phone (and possibly making it look less attractive) is a more prudent choice than damaging it because you dropped it.
- Switch the device off if its not going to be used for a long period of time.
- Keep the device away from moisture and liquids. Avoid taking the phone into areas like kitchens or washrooms.
- While charging the device, do not pull the adapter cord out from the device until the main electricity supply is switched off.
- Switch off the phone before removing the battery or changing your SIM card.
- Always use the rated and factory specified accessories for your phone. If, for example, you use a higher power rating for charging your phone, it could get charged faster but will lower the life of the battery or even damage the phone.

audio CD. The distinguishing feature of the Nokia 5510 is the full QWERTY keypad that is built into the phone. This makes it very simple to create SMS messages as you have the letters of the alphabet and numbers on individual keys. And yes, this phone also integrates an FM tuner.

The Siemens ME45 is another feature-rich phone with support for GPRS, full-fledged PIM functionality through reminders, To-do lists and calendaring. This phone also bundles a serial cable that can be used to connect the phone to a computer where its functionality can be controlled through the software that is supplied on an 8-cm CD.

Another phone that incorporated the

Cutting through the Hype

Should I go for GPRS?

Buy a cellular phone that supports GPRS only if your network supports it. Some service providers in India have upgraded their networks to GPRS. Check the network coverage of the service providers in your city so that the signal is at a useable level in the places you are going to use your phone. The best way to check this is to find out from other users if they get good signal strength in the areas you would normally be using your phone in.

What about those cool features?

While phones might incorporate features like Bluetooth support, MMS (Multimedia Messaging Service) and other stan-

dards, you should check whether your service provider supports these features and whether you have other devices that you can use the phone with. Some of the coolest features are those that do not depend on any external factors. Opt for phones with features such as predictive text entry for faster creation of SMS messages, robust PIM features, polyphony and a good amount of storage for contacts and messages. Other features to look for are whether you can download screensavers, operator logos and games. Internet connectivity via WAP/GPRS will depend on your network operator's support for it. Find out if this is available in your region before buying such a phone.

